

MEDIA ARTS

OVERVIEW

Media arts courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level focus on refining students' use of multiple media and their skills in the use of traditional and emerging technologies and tools. Students create increasingly sophisticated media art works that communicate ideas, feelings, and beliefs to specific audiences. These courses also develop students' theoretical knowledge and analytical skills, and encourage them to explore in greater depth the cultural, historical, and social contexts of media art.

Media arts incorporates a variety of materials, techniques, tools, technologies, and skills from various arts disciplines including dance, drama, music, and visual arts. Elements are also drawn from the contributing arts: for example, line, colour, and texture from visual arts; space, time, and energy from dance; rhythm (duration), harmony (pitch), and dynamics from music; and character, place, and tension from dramatic arts. The technologies and processes used and adapted to create media art may be traditional, including, but not limited to, photography, film, photocopy art, analog and electro-acoustic sound, classical animation, and video/television. The technologies and processes may also be digital: computer software, digital imaging and graphics, digital sound recording and sonic sculpture, two- and three-dimensional animation, multimedia production, holography, and web-page design.

Four organizing principles guide the creation of media artworks: *hybridization*, *interactivity*, *duration*, and *point of view*. Hybridization involves innovative ways of combining art disciplines to create what can be called "hybrid" forms of art. Duration explores the nature of time and how its perception can be manipulated and presented. Interactivity involves viewer participation and includes artforms such as interactive installations, performance art, gaming environments, and web-based art. Point of view can be expressed both conceptually – revealing, for example, an artist's response to a social theme or issue – and physically, through perspective.

The expectations for the courses in media arts are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. **Creating and Presenting:** Students apply the creative process (see pages 15–17) to construct and present media art works using traditional and emerging technology and tools in increasingly skillful ways. They create art works for multiple purposes and audiences, reflecting on the effectiveness of their use of the creative process. Students analyse how various artists use the principles of media art in the design and production of works that integrate elements from contributing arts.

2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** In this strand, students use the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) and the process of deconstruction to enhance their appreciation of media art works. Students reflect on their artistic choices to determine their effectiveness. They examine how media art works reflect personal and cultural identities, and affect personal, cultural, and community values. They assess and refine the skills needed for a range of careers and lifelong learning.
3. ***Foundations:*** In this strand, students deepen their understanding of theoretical concepts and expand their vocabulary for evaluating their own creations and those of other media artists. They analyse the roles of media artists and explore the historical and sociocultural contexts of media arts. Students demonstrate responsible practices when producing, presenting, and experiencing media art works.

Media Arts, Grade 11

Open

ASM30

This course enables students to create media art works using available and emerging technologies such as computer animation, digital imaging, and video, and a variety of media. Students will explore the elements and principles of media arts, the connections between contemporary media art works and traditional art forms, and the importance of using responsible practices when engaged in the creative process. Students will develop the skills necessary to create and interpret media art works.

Prerequisite: None

A. CREATING AND PRESENTING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the creative process to create media art works, individually and/or collaboratively;
- A2. The Principles of Media Arts:** design and produce media art works, applying principles of media arts and using various elements from contributing arts (dance, drama, music, visual arts);
- A3. Using Technologies, Tools, and Techniques:** apply traditional and emerging technologies, tools, and techniques to produce and present media art works for a variety of audiences and purposes.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use a variety of strategies (*e.g., a placemat or jigsaw exercise; brainstorming; sketches; a checklist; a concept web or mind map; research*) to generate and explore ideas, individually and collaboratively, for solutions to creative challenges (*e.g., creating a media art work on the signs of or issues relating to climate change in their community or on a cultural theme*)

Teacher prompts: “How can you use the collaborative process to develop and enrich your team’s ideas? What collaborative processes do artists’ collectives in your community use? Does an understanding of these processes widen the range of ideas that your team can explore?” “In what ways did your idea-generation process change when working in a group as opposed to by yourself?”

- A1.2** develop plans, individually and/or collaboratively, that address a range of creative challenges (*e.g., use outlines, scripts, diagrams, rough copies, templates, thumbnail sketches, storyboards, and/or production notes to help develop their plans; outline the steps in the creative process that they plan to apply*), and revise their plans on the basis of self-assessment and the input of others

Teacher prompt: “Does your plan clearly identify the steps you will follow and how they will allow you to address your challenge? When

you review your outline, can you see how you will move from one step to the next when you begin to produce your art work?”

- A1.3** produce and refine media art works, using experimentation, input, and reflection (*e.g., use their plan and outline to guide experimentation; use rating charts, self-assessment rubrics, simulations, journals, class critiques, and/or discussion boards to gather feedback and reflect on their preliminary work; refine their art work on the basis of peer input and self-assessment*)

Teacher prompts: “Have your experiments with new techniques been successful? How can you incorporate the results into your art work?” “What type of refinements did you make to your preliminary work as a result of constructive criticism? How did these refinements contribute to the successful completion of your art work?”

- A1.4** exhibit or perform media art works, individually and/or collaboratively, using a variety of methods that are appropriate for their work (*e.g., a classroom exhibition showcasing a variety of works on a social issue; an outdoor installation based on an environmental theme; a podcast on the significance of storytelling in First Nation, Métis, and/or Inuit cultures*)

Teacher prompts: “Did your presentation method affect the intended outcome of your media art work? Would another presentation method have been more effective?” “How did the site you selected for your installation influence the meaning of the work?”

A1.5 use a variety of tracking tools (e.g., sketchbooks, process journals, digital collections of images and sounds) to document in a detailed way their use of the creative process, and use this record as a basis for reflection on the effectiveness of their procedures

Teacher prompts: “Does your sketchbook allow you to reflect on how you approached each stage of the creative process in the production of your art work?” “Which specific steps did you follow in the creation of this work? Did the exploration stage result in changes to your initial idea or plans?”

A2. The Principles of Media Arts

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 communicate an understanding of the four principles of media arts, and apply one of them to reinterpret an existing art work (e.g., reinterpret South African photographer Santu Mofokeng’s Concert at Sevenfontein using the principle of duration)

Teacher prompt: “How can applying the principle of duration to transform a still photograph change the meaning and impact of the original work?”

A2.2 design and produce original media art works by combining two or more of the principles of media arts to organize a variety of elements from the contributing arts (e.g., use the principles of interactivity and duration to design and produce an environment that integrates a variety of elements in the style of Janet Cardiff’s Whispering Room)

Teacher prompt: “Which principles of media arts can you combine in your work to most effectively engage the audience?”

A3. Using Technologies, Tools, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 explore a variety of traditional and emerging technologies, tools, and techniques, and use them to produce effective media art works (e.g.,

use digital still or video cameras and image- or video-editing software; use available OSAPAC software; use 3D animation software to construct a virtual zoetrope or create a digital media art work; edit an existing sound file using MP3 sound-encoding software; use a digital recording device to store sounds for a soundscape based on an environmental theme)

Teacher prompts: “Does the virtual zoetrope provide insight into how you might create an optical illusion in your media art work?” “How does the inclusion of a soundscape enhance viewers’ experience of your landscape photographs?”

A3.2 use appropriate technology, tools, and techniques to create and present media art works that are appropriate for specific audiences (e.g., use techniques from manga art in making an animation for Grade 9 students; create an installation within the school that uses a variety of techniques to convey the meaning of a holiday connected to their cultural heritage)

Teacher prompt: “What revisions would you make to your animation if the audience changed from Grade 9 boys to Grade 12 girls?”

A3.3 communicate a personal message or an opinion on an issue of personal concern by creating and presenting media art works using a variety of techniques, tools, and/or technologies (e.g., an animated short to express their personal point of view on issues related to smoking; a series of ads for public spaces on reducing the size of our ecological footprint, using techniques similar to those of Adbusters)

Teacher prompts: “Which technologies do you find most useful in helping you communicate your personal ideas?” “Can you think of another technique that would enhance your ability to convey your opinion on this issue?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** demonstrate an understanding of the critical analysis process by examining, interpreting, assessing, and reflecting on media art works;
- B2. Identity and Values:** demonstrate an understanding of how media art works reflect personal and cultural identity, and affect personal, cultural, and community values and their awareness of those values;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the types of knowledge and skills developed in media arts and how they can be used outside the media arts classroom.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify and explain their initial responses to media art works (e.g., Sara Diamond's web-based work CodeZebra), using various strategies and modes of communication (e.g., a small-group or class discussion, a think-pair-share or jigsaw strategy, a blog, a journal, a sketchbook)

Teacher prompt: "How would you describe your first response to this art work? In what ways has this response been influenced by your personal experiences?"

- B1.2** identify, on the basis of investigation, the aesthetic and technical features of a contemporary media art work, and explain how and why the artist has combined these features in creating his or her work (e.g., identify the tools, techniques, technologies, and materials used by an artist, and explain how they have been used to create the art work; identify the individual elements, principles, and other aesthetic features of the art work, and explain, using jot notes, a digital recorder, comparison charts, a graphic organizer, or a web application, how and why the artist uses these features; explore the technical and aesthetic features of James Turrell's work Light Reign)

Teacher prompts: "How has the artist used and manipulated chat rooms, discussion boards, and video streaming in this art work?" "What

musical elements has the artist used to create sounds? What effect does the use of sound have on the audience?"

- B1.3** use the critical analysis process to evaluate the effectiveness of media art works (e.g., determine the intended effect of the work and assess whether that intent has been realized), and explain how their evaluation has evolved throughout the critical analysis process

Teacher prompts: "How effectively has the artist communicated a theme or position in this media art work? Is the artist successful in creating a desired effect? In generating debate?" "In what ways has your evaluation of this artist's work changed as you have analysed it more thoroughly?"

- B1.4** explain how applying the critical analysis process affects their use of the creative process when they are creating media art works (e.g., how the critical analysis process has informed their decision to use a particular technique, medium, element, or principle) and how it contributes to their understanding of the creative process in the work of other artists

Teacher prompts: "How did you use the critical analysis process to help you make artistic choices at different stages of the creative process?" "How can you use critical analysis to identify key features of the creative process in other media artists' work?"

B2. Identity and Values

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 identify and explain ways in which media art works reflect artists' personal identities (e.g., artists' values, beliefs, sexual orientation, learning challenges, socio-economic status)

Teacher prompt: "How do your artistic choices with respect to images, sounds, or topics reflect your identity? How can you use this understanding to analyse a media art work for clues as to the artist's personal identity?"

B2.2 explain ways in which media art works reflect cultural identity (e.g., works in the *ImaginATIVE Film and Media Arts Festival*; the work of Jenny Fraser)

Teacher prompt: "In what ways does a work such as Nam June Paik's *TV Buddha* reflect the artist's cultural identity?"

B2.3 identify and explain ways in which media art works can influence community or societal values (e.g., explore a range of advertisements on television, in public spaces, and in print media, and explain how they influence the immediate community and society at large; explore the effects of community-based broadcasting on the maintaining of cultural identity in Aboriginal communities)

Teacher prompt: "What methods do advertisements for advocacy groups such as Mothers Against Drunk Driving (MADD) use to try to change people's attitudes and practices?"

B2.4 explain, using a variety of formats (e.g., a digital collage with voice-over, an audio recording, a reflection journal), how creating and presenting media art works has affected their personal values and their understanding of their culture and community (e.g., how creating a documentary that expressed their impressions of their school culture has increased their understanding of the diversity of the student population)

Teacher prompt: "How did creating your interactive collage on climate change affect your own approach to the environment and your understanding of the values of your community?"

B2.5 explain how the process of critically analysing media art works has affected their understanding of the values of other cultures

and communities (e.g., how analysing the approach and message of, and tools used in, a work by a media artist from outside their own community/culture has expanded their understanding of another culture)

Teacher prompt: "In what ways has your analysis of Zacharias Kunuk's film *Atanarjuat / The Fast Runner* informed your understanding of the traditional values of Inuit culture?"

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 identify and describe, on the basis of research, areas for continued study in media arts and related fields, and describe their requirements (e.g., requirements for and content of media arts and contributing arts courses; opportunities for experiential learning)

B3.2 identify skills associated with media arts (e.g., planning and organizational skills; skills in using web-creation software or 2D and 3D animation software; skills related to digital imaging, digital sound recording, video editing), and explain how these skills can be applied in a range of careers related to media arts (e.g., e-learning designer, graphic artist, storyboard artist)

Teacher prompt: "What skills do you need to become a successful web designer or sound engineer? Explain why these skills are important in this career."

B3.3 identify and describe skills and understandings acquired through the creative and critical analysis processes in the media arts (e.g., organizational, planning, decision-making, interpersonal, and interpretation skills; more sophisticated understanding of social and environmental issues and anti-discriminatory practices), and explain how they can be applied in everyday life (e.g., to mediate a conflict; to analyse a music video or an advertisement and to assess its effect on their behaviour or purchasing decisions)

Teacher prompts: "How can you use your organizational skills to contribute to your community?" "What skills have you developed through your participation in collaborative processes in this course? How can you apply those skills in your relationships with your family or friends?"

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, elements, principles, and other concepts relating to media arts;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the sociocultural and historical contexts of media arts;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of responsible practices associated with producing, presenting, and experiencing media art works.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** describe the stages of the creative and critical analysis processes with reference to media art works, and explain and correctly use terminology related to the conventions and concepts of media arts when creating or analysing media art works (*e.g., use a graphic organizer to explain some of the stereotypes, symbols, styles, icons, structures, and/or recipes used in modern media*)
- C1.2** identify and describe a variety of elements from contributing arts that are used in media art works (*e.g., line and texture from visual arts, pitch and timbre from music, space and energy from dance, tension and relationship from drama*), and describe how these elements can be organized using one of the principles of media arts (*e.g., how elements from music and visual art can be organized using the principle of hybridization*)
- C1.3** explain terminology associated with the technologies, tools, and techniques used in the production and presentation of media art works (*e.g., audio mixing, camera angles, choreography, layering, light board, microphone, sound board, sound effects, transitions, zoom*), and use this terminology correctly when producing and presenting media art works

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** identify, through exploration, and explain (*e.g., in written critiques or presentations; using comparison charts, illustrations, or diagrams*) connections between a contemporary media art work and related historical art works (*e.g., the large-scale digital photographs of Chris Jordan and traditional still life paintings*)
Teacher prompt: “What are the similarities and differences between contemporary 3D animation films and Norman McLaren’s animations?”
- C2.2** demonstrate an understanding of the history and development of a media arts tool, medium, or technology (*e.g., create a video tracing the technological development of 2D animation from Eadweard Muybridge to the present; create a diagram tracing the history of audio technology; research and report on the history of performance media art*)
- C2.3** explain how sociocultural trends have contributed to the development of media arts (*e.g., how the widespread use of technologies such as cellphones, MP3 players, or LED lights have led to new ways of creating and presenting media art works; how human rights movements have influenced the message, media, or modes of presentation in media arts*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways has the widespread use of electronic surveillance devices recontextualized public spaces? How does Michael Naimark’s concept of camera zapping recontextualize the surveillance camera?” “In what context can electronic kiosks be considered art works?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify and apply healthy, safe, and conscientious work practices when performing tasks related to media arts production (*e.g., use safe practices when setting up for a video shoot, using and storing chemicals, packing up equipment, or setting up microphones; apply ergonomic principles in their studio environment; back up electronic files using a reliable system*)

Teacher prompts: “What steps should you take to ensure safety on a film set?” “What are the most stable ways of archiving video?”

C3.2 explain key ethical and legal practices associated with media arts, particularly with respect to copyright laws, and apply these practices when creating media art works (*e.g., obtain permission to sample photographs; use authorized sources when appropriating streaming video; show respect for cultural differences*)

Teacher prompt: “What is the difference between being inspired by another artist’s work and appropriating components of that work?”

C3.3 identify and apply responsible environmental practices associated with the media arts workplace (*e.g., reuse and recycle materials when possible; dispose of chemicals and batteries in environmentally safe ways; use energy conservation practices*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways can an individual media artist contribute to the environment?” “What environmentally friendly practices can you adopt when you are creating a media art work?”

C3.4 identify positive character traits associated with media arts production (*e.g., use a think-pair-share strategy to develop a storyboard for an animation based on positive traits; develop and maintain a work journal focusing on traits that contributed to successful interactions with others*), and exhibit these traits in both their independent work and their interactions with others

Teacher prompt: “What traits do you find most helpful in group members when you are involved in the collaborative process? When you are having difficulty with this process, why might a shift in the roles of group members be useful?”

C3.5 identify and appropriately apply conventions associated with the experiencing of media art works (*e.g., follow the policies of the presentation space with respect to noise, interaction with the works, and access to and movement within the space; respond in an appropriate way [silently, vocally, with clapping throughout or just at the end of a presentation], depending on the type of presentation; offer constructive criticism and meaningful praise*)